# Method planning grid

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AP RESEARCH · PLAN BEFORE YOU WRITE THE METHOD SECTION

STUDENT CODE _____ PERIOD _____ DATE _____

Copy your question from your log, word for word. Then plan each method in its own column. One method is fine: leave the second column empty.

_____

_____

| | Method 1: _____ | Method 2 (if you use one): _____ |
|---|---|---|
| **Why?** Why this method fits your question. Why this and not another method. | | |
| **What?** The instrument and how long it takes one person. | | |
| **When?** Dates, and how many times. | | |
| **Who?** Who you gather data from, how many, how you reach them. | | |
| **After gathering data** How you will analyze it and what you will compare. | | |

APPROVAL I NEED BEFORE I START

_____

METHODS TEXT I WILL CITE TO JUSTIFY THIS

_____

# What a filled-in grid looks like

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EXAMPLE ONLY · DO NOT COPY

The topic here is invented to show the level of detail: *how students use the library's quiet study room*. Your grid comes from your own question.

| | Method 1: Short questionnaire | Method 2: One-to-one interviews |
|---|---|---|
| **Why?** Why this method fits your question. Why this and not another method. | *To get counts: how often people use the room and at what times.* | *To learn the reasons behind the counts. Interviews, not a focus group, because schedules are personal and people speak more freely alone.* |
| **What?** The instrument and how long it takes one person. | *12 questions on paper. About 5 minutes.* | *6 open questions. About 15 minutes. Notes by hand, no recording.* |
| **When?** Dates, and how many times. | *One week, once per person, after approval is logged.* | *The week after the questionnaires come back.* |
| **Who?** Who you gather data from, how many, how you reach them. | *Students who use the room. Guardian permission and student assent first. Aim: every user that week.* | *Volunteers from the questionnaire group. Aim: 5 or 6.* |
| **After gathering data** How you will analyze it and what you will compare. | *Tally each answer. Compare by grade level. Report every count with its total.* | *Code the notes for repeated reasons. Report each theme with how many people raised it.* |

**What to notice.** Every "why" names a reason, and one rejects an alternative. The second method explains the first: the interviews give reasons for the counts. The "who" for Method 2 comes out of Method 1. Each "after" says what will be compared and how it will be reported.

**If two methods do not connect, you have two small studies.**
**Ask: what does Method 2 tell me that Method 1 cannot?**

CHECK YOUR OWN GRID

- Could a classmate run my study from this page alone?
- Does each "why" give a reason, not a description?
- Is the time I ask of each person stated?
- Do I know what approval I need, and have I allowed time for it?
- Can I name what my data will **not** be able to show?